

Diablos-Miners Affair Will Benefit UTEP Fund

By PETE CICCARELLI

The El Paso Diablos will make their El Paso debut April 17th at Dudley Field when they play a benefit baseball game with the University of Texas at El Paso, officials of both teams announced today.

The 2 p.m. contest will require an admission fee of \$1. per person with all proceeds going to the baseball scholarship fund at the university.

"We're very pleased that we could arrange to play Andy's club this first season," Diablo General Manager Jim Paul

commented. "This will give our club a chance to meet the public and at the same time service a constructive purpose for the community by strengthening the athletic program at UTEP."

COHEN, a longtime professional baseball figure in the southwest, feels the contest can aid in providing the Miners with experience he feels the club will be lacking. "It's always easier to learn how to do things the proper way when you're on the field watching someone else do it," Andy remarked. "Playing a professional club gives us a birdseye view of how to execute. With some strong pitching I think we can hold our own against them."

"But watch out," Paul quickly warned. "If you guys beat us bad our season ticket sales can go right down the drain."

The Diablos open their 1974 Texas League baseball season April 19th at Dudley.

ABA Prepares War Council

SAN FRANCISCO (UPI) — The American Basketball Assn., its feathers ruffled when the rival National Basketball Assn. dragged its feet on an agreed merger, declared war today on the NBA.

The first step in its campaign to force a merger or break up the NBA's stranglehold on sites and players, was taken when the ABA filed an antitrust suit in San Francisco Federal Court.

lators and the public with fraudulent statements and has avoided a merger at every turn."

THE TWO leagues signed an agreement in May 1971, which the ABA says bound the leagues to work together toward a merger and jointly urge Congress to pass legislation exempting such a merger from antitrust laws.